



Prospering Together: Laramie County's Path to a Sustainable Future

Funded by the EPA Climate Pollution Reduction Planning Grant

Introductions



Agenda

- Project Overview
- The Data
- Engagement Process
- Plan Focus Areas, Measures, and Goals



Project Overview

- Funded by the Climate Pollution Reduction Grant from the US Environmental Protection Agency
- Cheyenne selected Lotus as the vendor
- Workplan includes:
 - GHG Inventories
 - Engagement
 - Goals, Measures, and Strategies
 - Final Plan



Timeline

PHASE 1

March

- Information session
- Website launch
- Community context analysis

PHASE 2

April – August

- Rapid surveys
- Sector meetings
- Emissions inventory
- Business as Usual Projections
- Informational interviews
- Tabling at community events
- Prioritization of Measures & Actions

PHASE 3

Sept – October

- Educational flyers
- Engagement Synthesis
- Strategy Matrix

PHASE 4

Nov – February

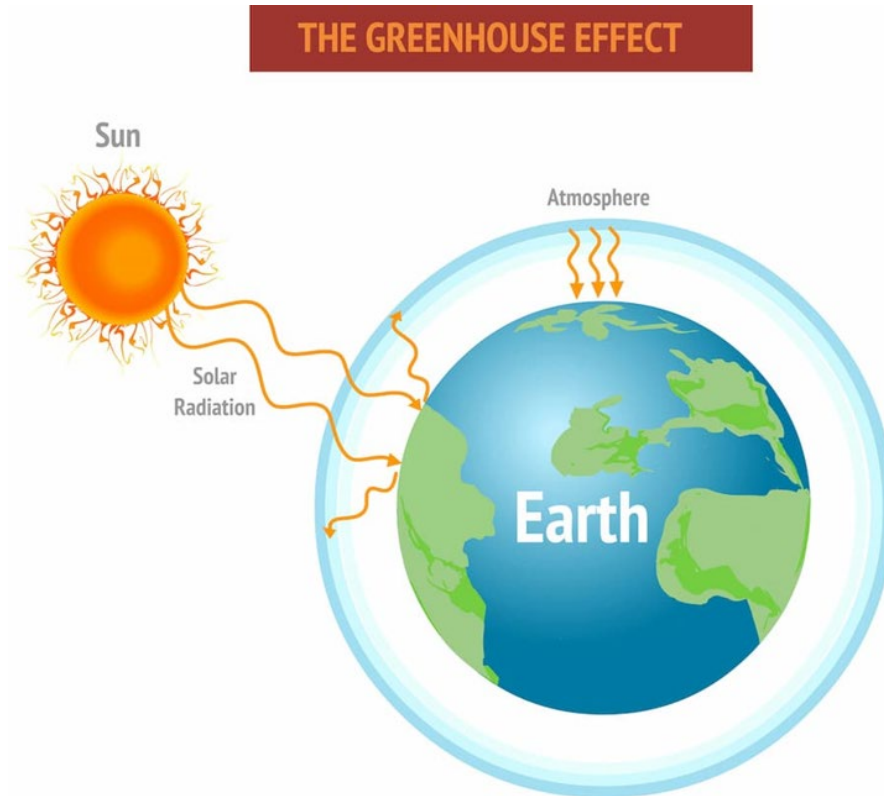
- Implementation Elements
- Educational flyers
- Draft & Final Report

The Data



GHG Emissions and Climate Change

- Greenhouse gases (GHGs) create a buffer in Earth's atmosphere.
- More GHGs in the atmosphere = more heat trapped in the atmosphere.
- This can lead to increased temperatures, extreme precipitation, flash flooding, worse air pollution, etc.
- Decreasing emissions can help mitigate these environmental changes.



Air quality alert issued for all of Wyoming due to wildfire smoke

Ashley Morgan Sep 4, 2025 | Updated Sep 4, 2025

Smoke from Elk and Pack Trail fires settles over Cheyenne, parts of southeast Wyoming

Hannah Shields Wyoming Tribune Eagle Oct 7, 2024 Updated Oct 7, 2024 [Comments](#)



 Wyoming News Now

Southern Wyoming continues to be impacted by wildfire smoke from Colorado and Utah

Cheyenne, Wyo. - Wildfires in Western Colorado and Utah continue to bring smoky and hazy conditions across southern Wyoming.

Aug 6, 2025

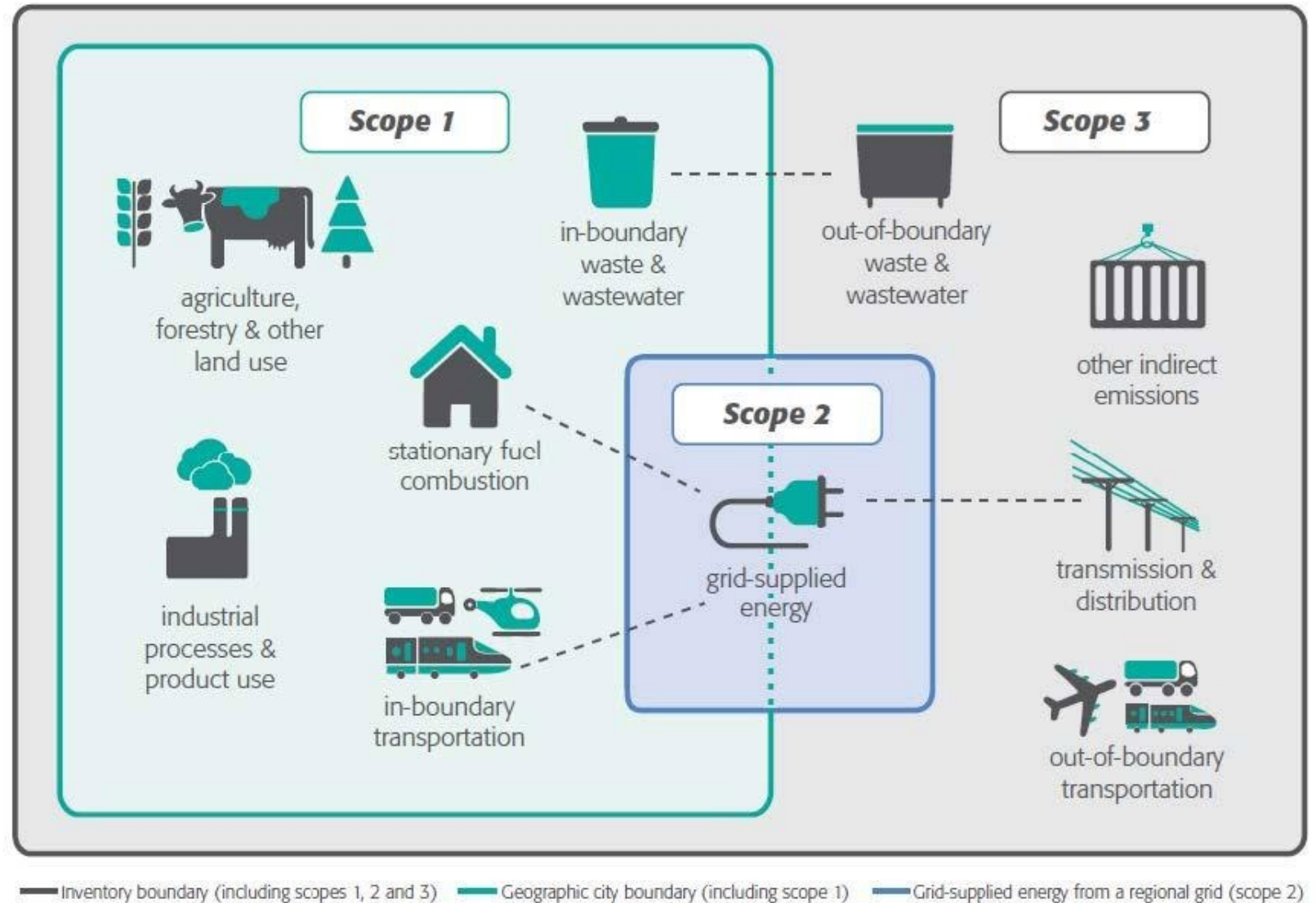


Powerful storm hits Cheyenne with hail, funnel clouds on 40th anniversary of 1985 flood

Alyssa Tolman Wyoming Tribune Eagle Aug 2, 2025 Updated Aug 2, 2025 [Comments](#)

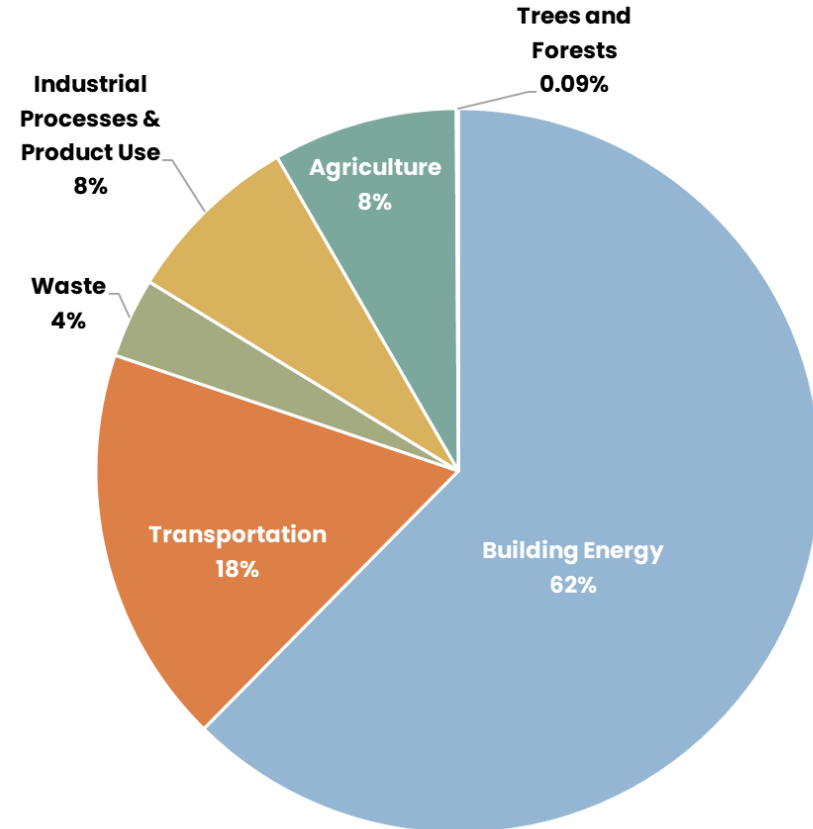
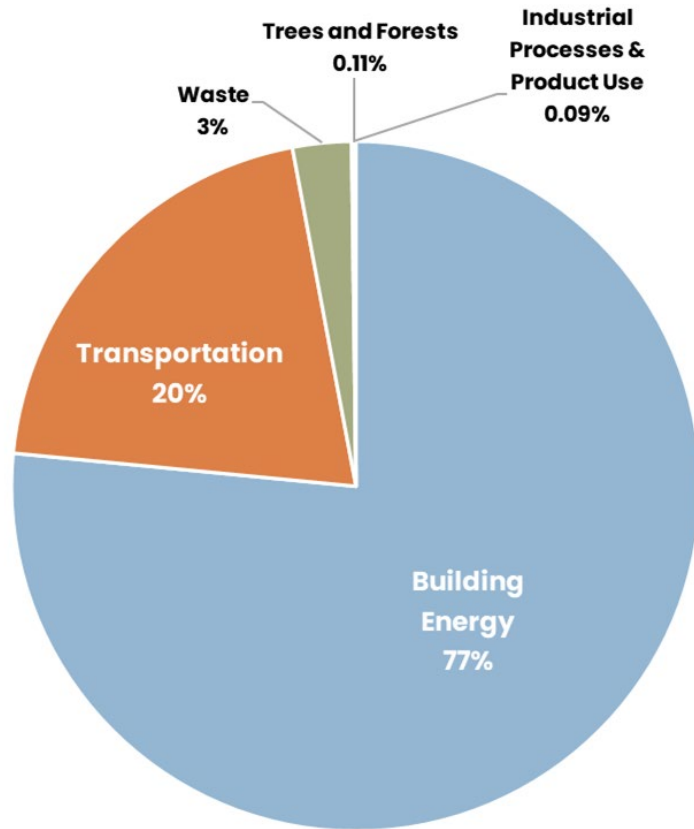


What is a GHG Inventory?

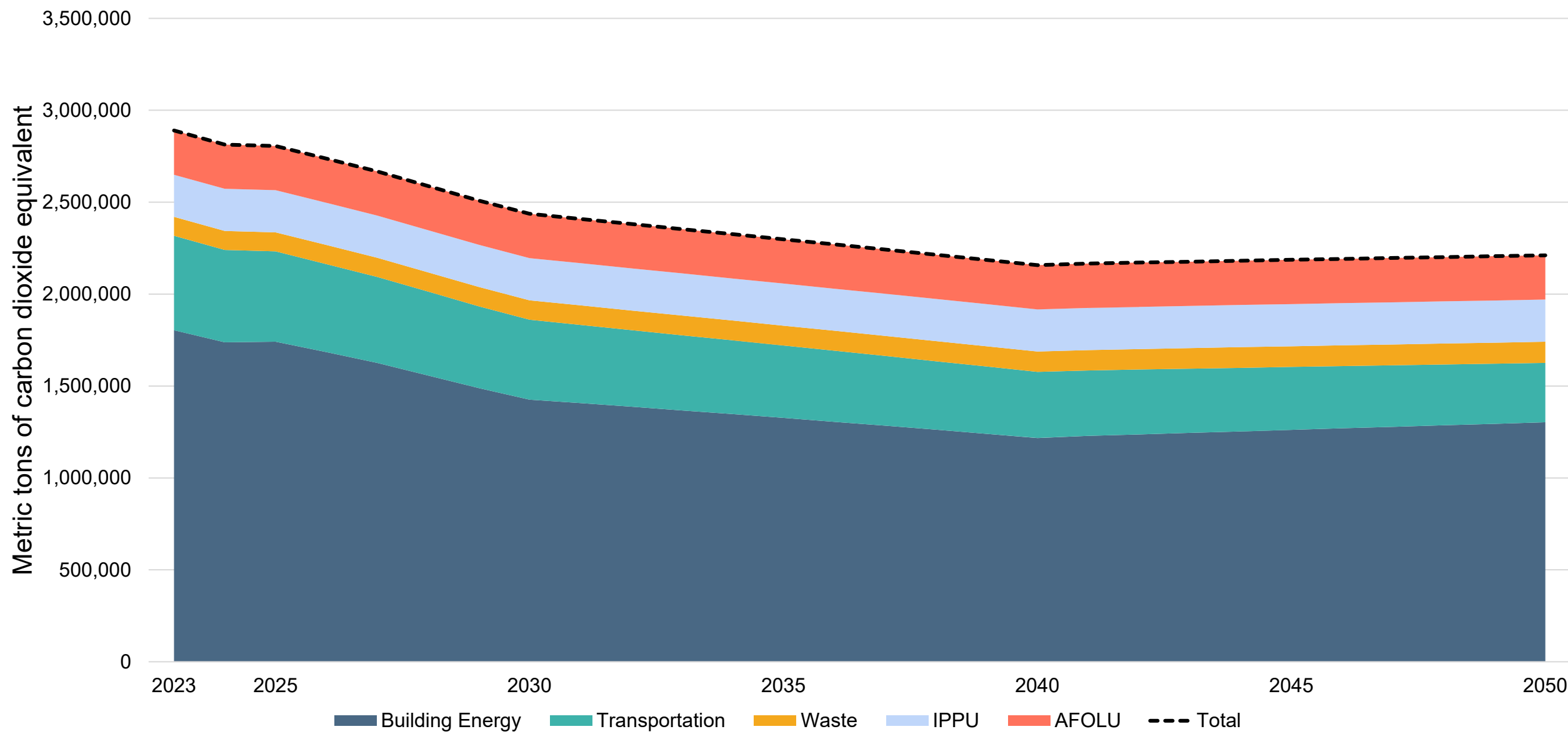


Overall Community Emissions in 2023

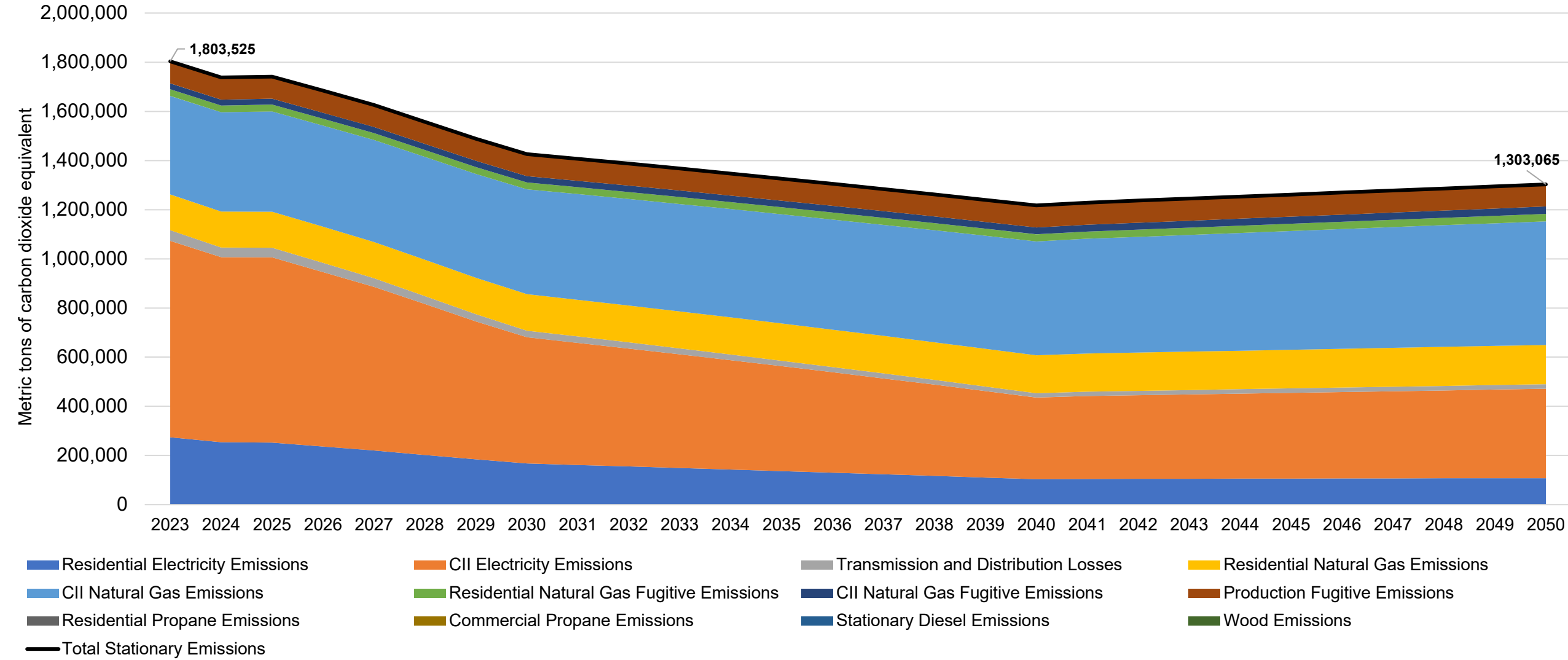
Cheyenne (mt CO ₂ e)	Cheyenne MSA (mt CO ₂ e)
1,093,474	2,890,187



Cheyenne MSA Business-as-Usual Emissions Projection (2023-2050)



Cheyenne MSA Stationary Energy Business-as-Usual Emissions Projection





Engagement Process

Engagement by the Numbers

Engagement	Number of Engagements	Participation
In Person Workshops	3	64 stakeholders
Informational Interviews	22	28 stakeholders
Virtual Sector Meetings	3	20 stakeholders
Cheyenne Employee Picnic	1	77 employees
Rapid Surveys	2	363 respondents
Website Forum	1	68 respondents
Total Number of Engagements	32	Total Participation
		620



Cheyenne Employee Picnic



Engagement Synthesis

Key Themes

**Public
Engagement and
Education Efforts**

**Energy Efficiency
and Building
Retrofits**

**Housing
Affordability**

**Safe, Active
Transportation
Options**



Workshops: Feedback

What are 1-2 core values that define the Cheyenne and Laramie County community?

Key themes identified



Affordable housing



Supporting key vulnerable communities



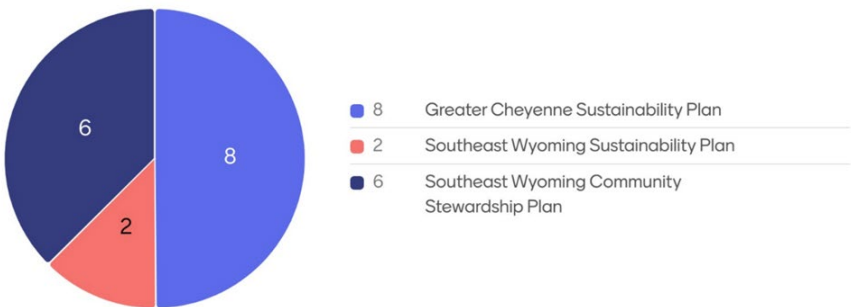
Water supply



Aging population



What should we name the plan?



Interviewees

City Council	City Staff	Workforce and Energy Providers	County and State Staff	Community Based Organizations
2 total	- City of Cheyenne Building Official - City of Cheyenne Community Recreation and Events - City of Cheyenne Stormwater Division Manager - City of Cheyenne Transit Director	- Cheyenne Regional Medical Center - High West Energy - Laramie County Community College	- Laramie County Conservation District - Wyoming State Parks and Cultural Resources	- American Civil Liberties Union - American Federation of Labor and Congress of Industrial Organizations (Wyoming AFL-CIO) - Audubon - Better Wyoming - Cheyenne Children's Museum - Juntos - Laramie County Community Partnership - Laramie County Health Matters – Better Together Action Team - National Advancement Association Colored People - Wyoming Civic Engagement Network - Wyoming Independent Citizens Coalition



Informational Interviews: Feedback

Key themes identified



Affordable housing



Public engagement



Business and job creation



Sector Meetings: Feedback

Key themes identified



Energy efficiency and building retrofits



Waste management



Safe, active transportation



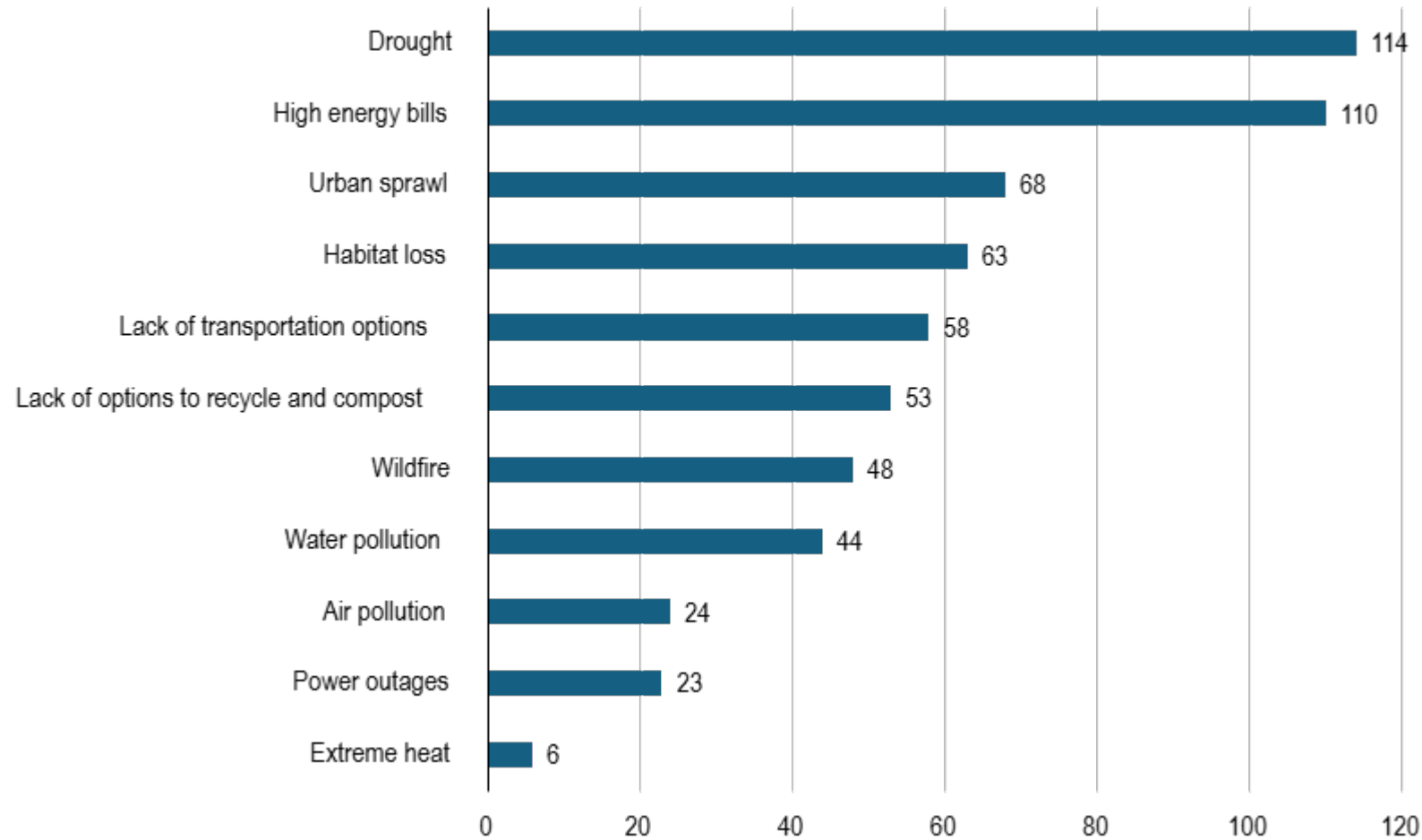
Employee Picnic: Feedback

Strategy	Votes
Workforce development	132
Natural resource protection	126
Water conservation programs	119
Increase safety of walking and biking	110
Recycling and composting	97
Education about energy efficiency	72
Rebates for energy efficiency	64
On-site solar, wind, geothermal	46
Alternative fuel vehicles and EV charging	15



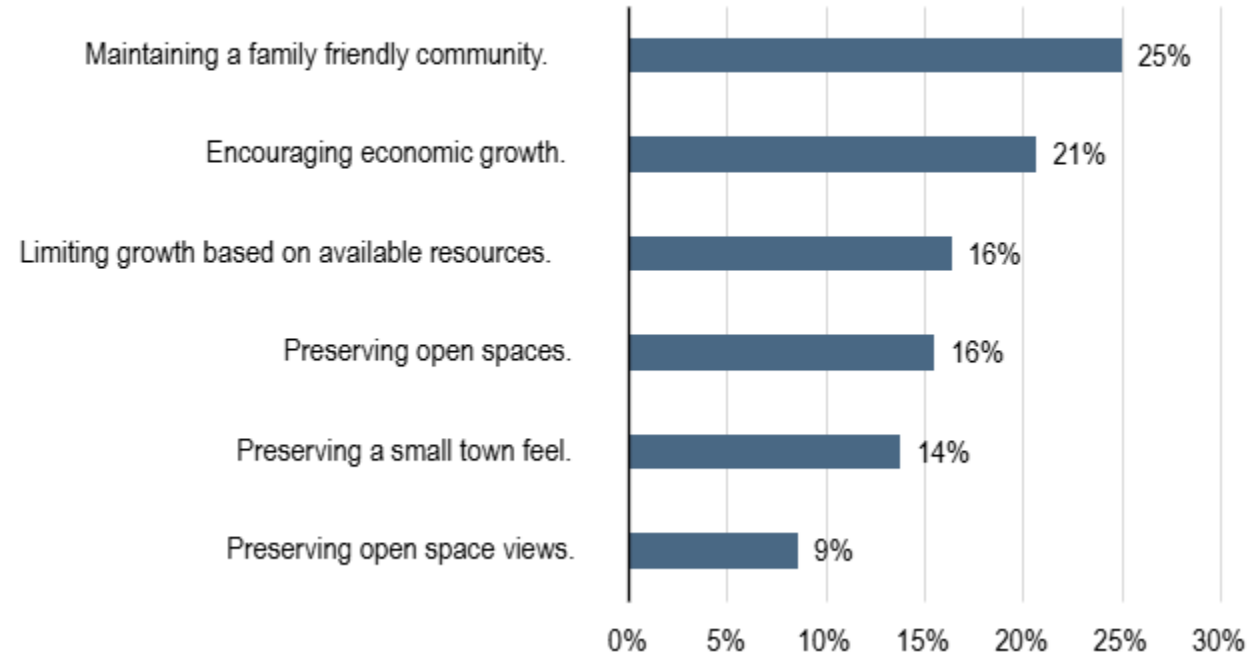
Rapid Surveys: Feedback

What sustainability issues do you think are most important to address?



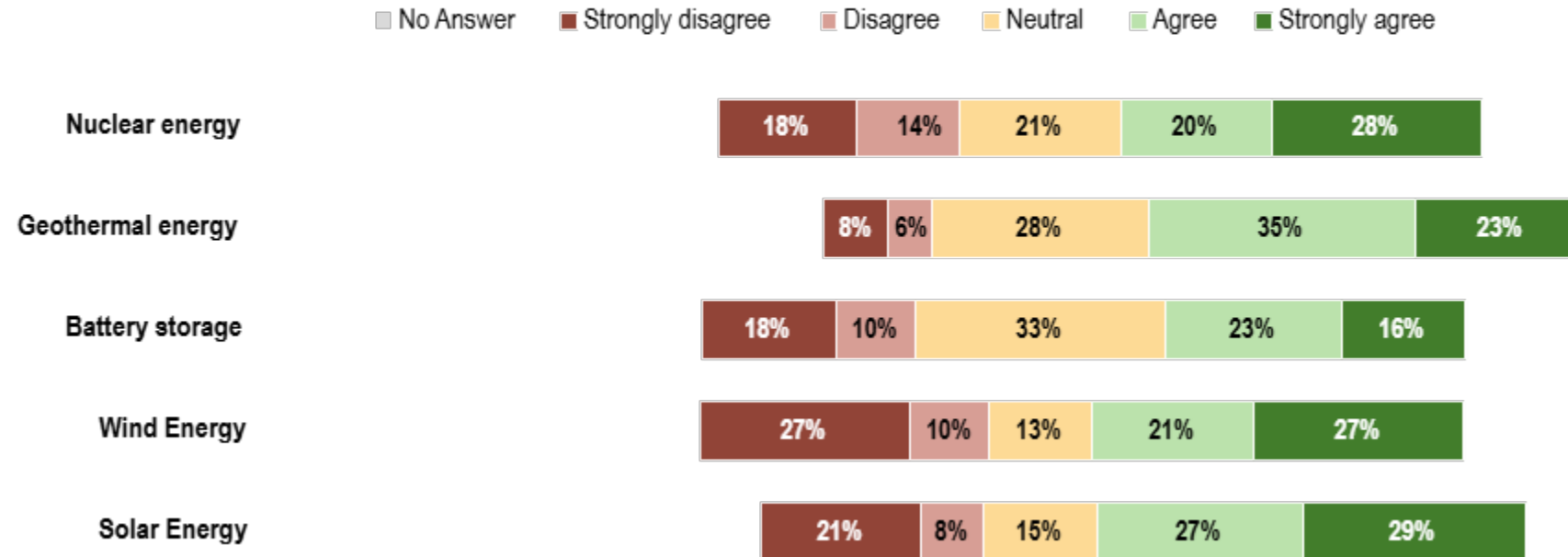
Rapid Surveys: Feedback

What is most important to you?



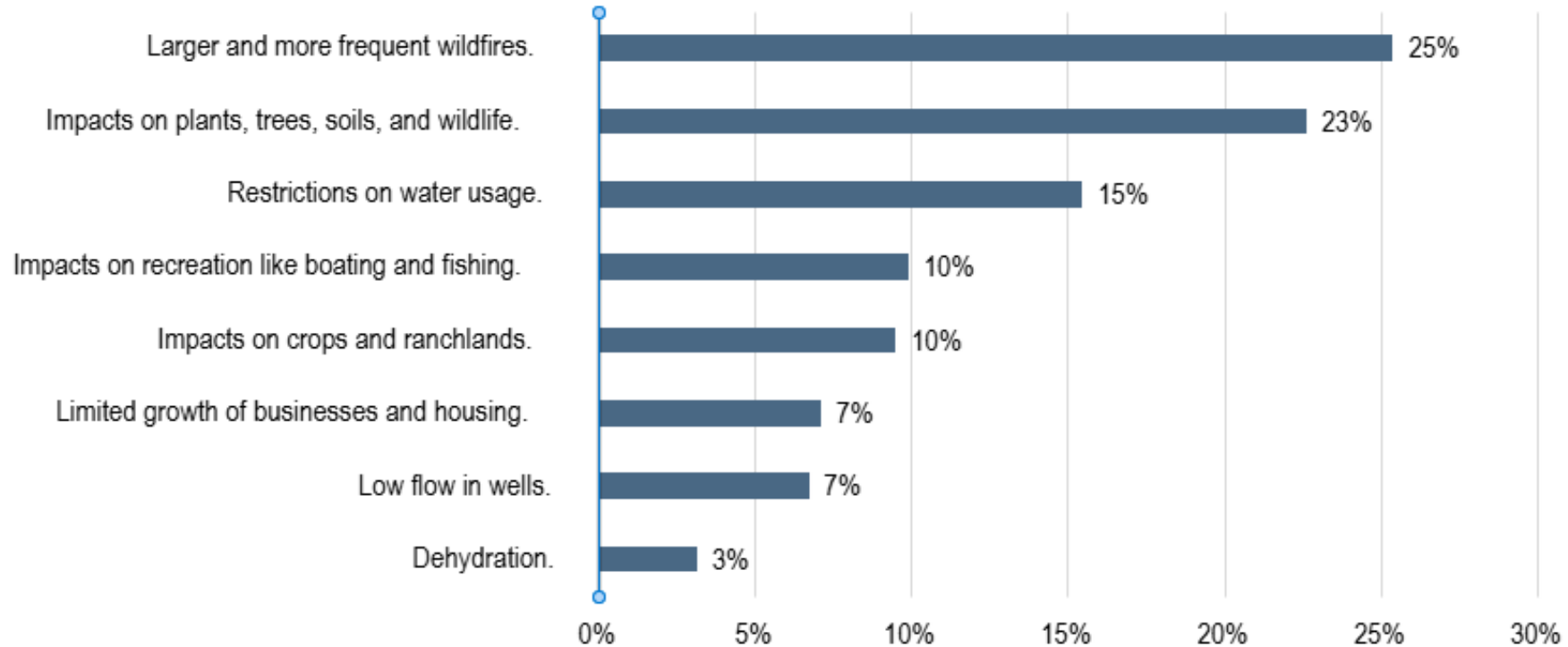
Rapid Surveys: Feedback

Attitude towards alternative energy sources



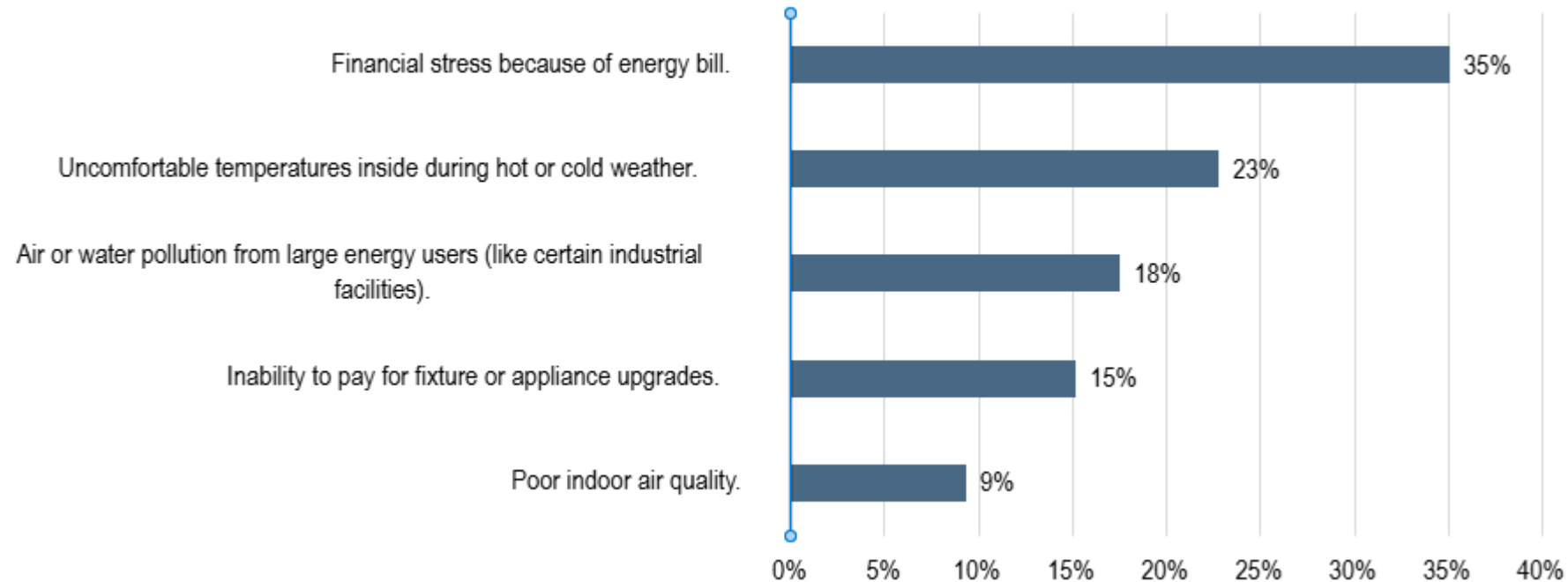
Rapid Surveys: Feedback

What challenges have you experienced or seen relating to drought?



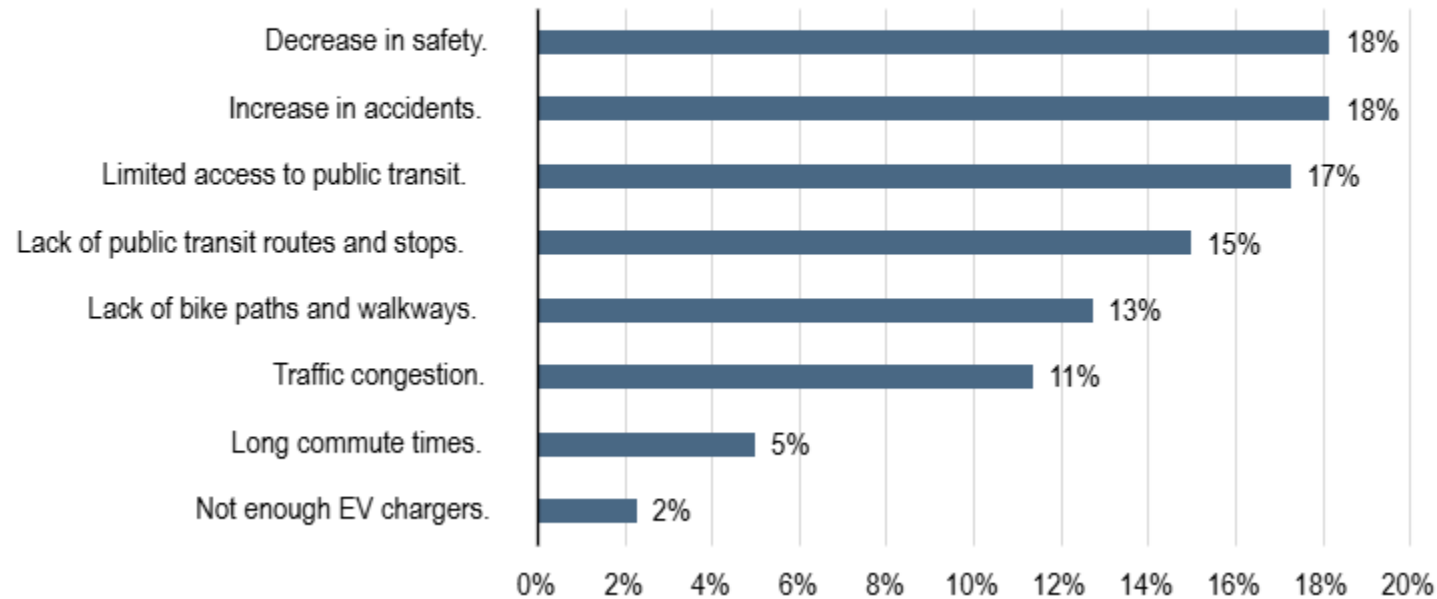
Rapid Surveys: Feedback

What challenges have you experienced or seen relating to energy usage?



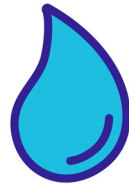
Rapid Surveys: Feedback

What challenges have you experienced or seen relating to transportation?



Website Forum: Feedback

Key themes identified



Water supply



Improving community services



A serene landscape at sunset or sunrise. The sky is a mix of soft pinks, oranges, and blues, with wispy clouds catching the low light. Below the horizon, a dense line of dark green trees stands against the colorful sky. The foreground is a calm body of water that perfectly reflects the sky and the trees, creating a symmetrical effect. The overall mood is peaceful and contemplative.

Plan Focus Areas, Measures, and Goals

Plan Vision

“To create a healthy and prosperous community that embraces our unique way of life through efficient utilization of resources, environmental stewardship, and collective action.”



Plan Focus Areas



**Energy and
Buildings**



Transportation



Workforce



**Waste and
Water**



**Natural and
Working Lands**



Transportation

- Goal #1: Reduce cars on the road while ensuring it is safe to bike and walk.
- Goal #2: Provide easy access to multiple transportation options that connect people from where they live to where they work, shop, etc.



Transportation Measures

- Improve the active transportation network in Cheyenne to reduce traffic related incidents and encourage walking and biking.
- Promote the adoption of alternative fuel vehicles.
- Increase connectivity across the county and across the region into Colorado and Nebraska.
- Shift commuter patterns from single occupancy vehicles to transit.



Energy and Buildings

- Goal #1: Increase the adoption of energy efficiency measures to reduce ongoing energy bills and mitigate emissions.
- Goal #2: Expand clean energy development (solar, geothermal, wind, and nuclear) to diversify the region's economy and reduce emissions.
- Goal #3: Strategically repurpose existing buildings and encourage new buildings to have a lower impact.
- Goal #4: Ensure there is enough affordable housing to meet the demand and a variety of housing types.



Energy and Buildings Measures

- Increase energy efficiency and electrification in residential buildings.
- Increase energy efficiency and electrification in commercial and industrial buildings.
- Encourage adoption of clean energy.
- Implement policies and programs that reduce the overall impact of buildings.
- Implement policies and programs that increase the availability of affordable housing.



Workforce

- Goal #1: Build a pipeline of skilled workers that aligns with workforce trends across key industries to promote economic vitality.
- Goal #2: Ensure that as Cheyenne grows into a workforce hub, environmental impacts are taken into account.
- Goal #3: Enhance the quality of life to attract new workers and retain the young population.



Workforce Measures

- Provide training and workforce development programs that promote the creation and accessibility of high-quality jobs.
- Support businesses in adopting resource conservation practices.
- Ensure that families moving into Cheyenne have access to essential resources nearby.



Waste Management and Water

- Goal #1: Reduce waste and ensure the longevity of the landfill.
- Goal #2: Provide a resilient and reliable water supply and protect the region's water quality.



Waste and Water Measures

- Increase the proportion of waste that is recycled and composted while reducing contamination levels.
- Promote water conservation and responsible water use to protect existing water sources and provide a resilient and reliable water supply.
- Improve water quality and enhance stormwater management.



Natural and Working Lands

- Goal #1: Preserve and protect sensitive, rare, and unique natural areas.



Natural and Working Lands Measures

- Ensure agriculture lands and rangelands protect and conserve natural resources and sequester carbon.
- Manage development to protect natural lands and wildlife.
- Improve the management of natural spaces.





Questions?



Thank you!

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